Example Task

A complete Long-Horizon task, end to end, adapted to Spec V2 · Updated October 26, 2026

This task was selected by the ML team as a high-quality example. Everything below is real output from it. The original was built with a golden answer and two hints; what follows shows the same work expressed the V2 way, as Oracle Events.

Change log

Date	Updates
Oct 26, 2026	Prompt cleaned up: capitals and apostrophes restored, and the line hinting at the trap removed. The baseline ran on the original. New section 9: the same task, done badly.
Oct 19, 2026	Baseline table note updated: new tasks run on Opus 5.5.
Oct 7, 2026	Baseline table notes that this run used Opus 5.5. New tasks run on Opus 4.8.
Sep 26, 2026	Replaced with the ML-selected task and adapted to Spec V2. Golden answer re-expressed as Oracle Events. Hint, reference run and silver-trajectory sections removed. Baseline model updated to Opus 5.5.
Aug 2026	Original release.

1 · The assignment

Axis	Value
Persona	Marcus Bennett — Artist (Design)
Competency	Marketing and GTM
Task skill	Analysis and Synthesis, stacked with Retrieval and Actions
Task type	Long-Horizon
Characteristics	Ambiguity · Dynamic Change · Multi-Source
Services that carry weight	Slack · Snowflake · GitHub · Confluence · Linear · Trello
Injected friction	None
Human time estimate	10 hours

Note how the persona and the competency relate. Marcus is an artist, not a marketer — but he made the marketing videos, the capture tool and the playable visual effects, so the GTM work genuinely went through him. That is what a well-chosen competency looks like: not the obvious match for the job title, but a defensible one.

2 · The prompt

> ```
> Robert wants the Combo Fighters launch written down properly before
> Leonard archives everyone's Google accounts on February 15, and honestly
> I don't think anybody actually knows what state it's in. I did the
> marketing videos and the capture tool and the playable VFX so most of the
> creative side went through me, but the campaign and the paid side was
> Leonard and I only ever saw pieces of it in chat. Can you work out what
> really happened and what is still genuinely open? Then put the record
> somewhere proper next to the rest of the launch stuff and raise tickets
> for whatever someone needs to pick up. After this week there's nobody
> left to ask.
> ```

The baseline in section 6 ran on an earlier wording of this prompt. It was all lowercase, left out the apostrophes and also asked for “what we actually shipped and spent versus what people think we did”, a line that hints at the trap.

Why it works

Property	How the prompt achieves it
It reads like real typing	Normal capitals and spelling, no markdown, one long run-on sentence that doubles back. Nothing an AI-text detector would flag
It names nothing	No document, no channel, no ticket, no figure. It names a deadline and a feeling
It has two phases	Work out what happened, *then* write the record and raise the tickets — investigation and action
It leaves the trap hidden	Nothing warns the agent about the summaries it will find. It has to work out for itself that the newest one is wrong
It justifies the persona	Marcus explains what he did and did not see, which is why he is asking rather than answering
It is not pre-solved	Nothing in it says what the answer is. “I don't think anybody actually knows” is the opposite of a root cause
It has unique ground truth	The route varies; the destination does not. One record, filed alongside the launch material, plus tickets for the open items

> **THE DATE**
>
> “February 15” is absolute and sits one day after the frozen clock — which is exactly right. It is a *deadline*, not a description of something that already happened. A prompt describing a February 15 event as completed would be a failing error.

3 · What was seeded

One Slack message, from Robert, dated February 13, 2026:

```
"before Leonard archives everything I want the combo fighters launch
 written down somewhere that isn't this channel. As far as I'm concerned
 we shipped it and ran it across all the networks we wired up, meta was
 just the biggest spend. The playable is the only thing I'd call
 unfinished. Correct me if I'm wrong on any of that."
```

It is the newest message on the subject, it comes from the chief product officer, and it addresses the persona by name. Both halves of it are wrong, in opposite directions:

- **"we ran it across all the networks"** — meta was the only network that ever bought an install. The other six names in the codebase are monetization placements, not acquisition channels.
- **"the playable is the only thing I'd call unfinished"** — the playable is the one creative that actually shipped.

> **THIS IS DYNAMIC CHANGE DONE PROPERLY**
>
> The most authoritative-sounding summary in the universe is the thing the agent has to overturn. And it is not a truthfulness defect on the author's part — truthfulness applies to what *you* assert in the prompt, not to what a character believes. Robert being wrong is realistic, and his own message ends with "Correct me if I'm wrong on any of that."

4 · The Oracle Events

Nine events cover the critical path. Three of them, in full:

```
OE 2  Establish which build the January approval message refers to.
      slack_conversations_history (channel C09UHHN6PFZ, 2026-01-17..20)
      Expected: 1.0.56 posted 01-17; approval 01-19 06:41; 1.0.57
      submitted 06:44 and released 01-20.

OE 4  Aggregate paid spend by network for the title.
      Snowflake AD_SPEND_DAILY, filter game_id = combo_fighter
      Expected: 152 rows, channel = meta on all of them, 4510.33 USD,
      615 paid installs, 2025-12-26 to 2026-02-08.

OE 7  Read the 2026-02-11 playable thread to its end, not to 21:08.
      Expected: rejection 21:03, workaround 21:10, "it works" 21:22,
      campaign on 21:37, bid set 21:42, iOS-only confirmed 21:54.
```

What makes them good

- **Every event names the service, the filter and the expected values.** That is what `/oe` checks against, and it is what lets the rubric be written without going back into the universe.
- **OE 7 is the whole task in one event.** The instruction is explicitly "to its end, not to 21:08" — the author knew where the agent would stop and recorded the correct behaviour precisely.
- **No event describes the final response.** OE 4 records what the query returns, not what the write-up should say about it. The write-up is the rubric's business.
- **No non-actions.** Nothing says "the agent does not stop early". OE 7 says what reading to the end actually produces.

5 · The rubric set

31 criteria, all Outcome. No Process rubric was needed, because every requirement was provable from the final record. That is a perfectly normal shape for a task this size.

Wt	Criterion (abbreviated)	Why that weight
1	Agent's record states build 1.0.10 was reviewed and published on 2025-12-21	One source, literal lookup, no reconciliation and no reasoning
1	Agent's record identifies Leonard's February 15 archive as the deadline	Stated directly in the seeded message
3	Agent's record states lifetime installs total 901 — 615 paid plus 286 organic, split 695 iOS and 206 Android	One aggregation over the install tables. Two axes: discovery effort and reasoning depth
3	Agent's record states the playable shipped and was live on iOS	Requires reading one thread past its apparent conclusion
5	Agent's record classifies the AppLovin, Unity, Ironsource, AdMob, liftoff and mintegral mentions as monetization placements that bought no installs	Slack, GitHub and Snowflake all have to be reconciled against each other, and a distinction has to be inferred that no single source states
5	Agent's record establishes that 1.0.57, not 1.0.56, is the build that went to store review	Three timestamps across two services, with a three-minute gap that decides the answer

What the set deliberately does not do

- ✗ It does not require a document titled “Combo Fighters Launch Record”. It requires a launch record in the same folder as the existing launch material.
- ✗ It does not require a section header called “Confirmed vs Pending”. It requires confirmed items to be separated from pending ones.
- ✗ It does not enumerate branches. Where more than one filing location was defensible, the criterion is phrased broadly enough that either satisfies it.
- ✗ It does not grade every row of the spend data. It grades the totals, the classification, and the two figures that only exist after reconciliation.

6 · The baseline

Measurement	Result
Model	Opus 5.5 (the baseline at the time; new tasks also use Opus 5.5)
Rollouts	6, all completed
Best rollout	**18 of 31**
pass@1	**0**
Tool calls, best rollout	70
Totals reported	Every one correct
Consequential findings	**Both inverted**

Opus reported the playable as unfinished and the title as live on Google Play. Both are false, and both are exactly what Robert's message claimed. The model found the data, computed it correctly, and then deferred to the most confident-sounding summary in the channel.

> **WHERE THE DIFFICULTY ACTUALLY SAT**
>
> Not in the volume of data — the model handled 12,100 messages and several Snowflake tables without trouble. It sat in **knowing when not to stop**. The playable thread reads like it concluded at 21:08; the story continues until 21:54. That single structural choice is what produced a task nothing passed.

7 · The human time estimate

```
Read the channel across the launch window, ~12,100 messages  ~4 hr
Reconstruct the build history from the submission messages   ~45 min
Read the playable thread past the apparent conclusion        ~20 min
Pull daily spend, installs and revenue by hand               ~2 hr
Reconcile the design doc against the data                    ~30 min
Find the PRs and confirm what each contains                  ~40 min
Write the record, then raise the tickets                     ~1 hr 45
                                                      total  ~10 hr
```

The justification includes the dead ends: a person without search tooling scrolls the wrong month, reads the partner channel that covers the same window for a different title, and opens marketing documents belonging to the other two games. The arithmetic adds up to the number entered, which is what the step requires.

8 · What to take from this task

1. **Seed one message, not ten.** A single authoritative-but-wrong summary from a senior person did more work than any amount of additional data would have.
2. **Put the correction second in discovery order.** The trap only works because the agent meets the claim before it meets the evidence that overturns it.

3. **Name nothing in the prompt.** Every channel, document and figure the agent needs was discoverable. None was handed over.
4. **Write Oracle Events with real values in them.** “152 rows, all `channel = meta`, 4510.33 USD” is what makes both `/oe` and the rubric step straightforward.
5. **Weight by difficulty.** The criterion that carries the task's whole point — a record exists in the right place — is not the highest-weighted one. The reconciliations are.
6. **All-Outcome is fine.** If every requirement is provable from the final state, you do not need a single Process criterion.

9 · The same task, done badly

This version uses the same task, written badly on purpose with the mistakes reviewers find most often, so you can compare it with sections 2, 4 and 5. Each numbered marker points to a problem explained below it.

Prompt

> Please conduct a comprehensive review of the Combo Fighters launch. (1) Use slack_conversations_history on channel C09UHHN6PFZ and query AD_SPEND_DAILY in Snowflake. (2) The issue is that Robert thinks we ran ads on every network, but the other networks were only ad placements, and the playable did ship. (3) Create a Google Doc titled “Combo Fighters Launch Record” with the findings, or just summarise it back to me if that's easier. (4) Also, can you book a meeting with Julia next week to go over Q2 plans? (5)

- (1) **Contrived.** Formal wording that reads like an LLM wrote it. The AI-text detector would flag it.
- (2) **Explicit tool mention (Fail) and an opaque ID.** It names a function and a raw channel ID that Marcus would never type. It also tells the agent where to look, which removes the discovery.
- (3) **Pre-solved (Fail).** It gives away both findings the task is built around.
- (4) **Multiple Valid Answers (Fail).** One run writes a doc, another just replies. A Google Doc is also a weak home when the Google accounts are being archived.
- (5) **Bolt-on (Fail) and a relative date.** The meeting has nothing to do with the launch record, and “next week” isn't an absolute date.

Oracle Events

```
OE 1  The agent searches Slack for the launch discussion.
OE 2  The agent looks at the ad data in Google Sheets.
      Expected: spend was mostly Meta.
OE 3  The agent does not stop at the first message it finds.
OE 4  The agent's final response explains that Robert was wrong
      about the networks and the playable.
OE 5  The agent creates the Google Doc.
```

- **OE 1 has no Expected line.** Nothing to check against the universe.
- **OE 2 names the wrong service and a wrong fact (Inaccurate).** The spend is in Snowflake, not Sheets, and every Combo Fighters row there is Meta, not “mostly”.
- **OE 3 is a non-action.** “Does not stop” isn't a step. OE 7 in section 4 says what reading to the end actually finds.

- **OE 4 describes the final response.** That belongs in the rubric.
- **OE 5 has no location and no Expected line.**
- **Incomplete.** The build history, the GitHub check, the playable thread, the installs and revenue, and the tickets have no steps at all.

Rubric

Wt	Criterion	Problem
5	The Agent creates a Google Doc titled “Combo Fighters Launch Record”.	Hard-coded title the prompt only set because it was badly written, and a location that won't survive the Google archive. Section 5 asks for a launch record in the same folder as the existing launch material.
3	The response identifies the build that was approved.	Not self-contained: doesn't say it was 1.0.56, so any build number passes.
5	The Agent reports that the launch ran on all the ad networks they wired up and that the playable is unfinished.	Incorrect: repeats both of Robert's wrong claims. Also two facts in one criterion.
3	The Agent does not trust Robert's message.	Negative framing with no prohibition in the prompt, and nothing a grader can see.
1	The Agent uses slack_conversations_history to read the prototype channel.	Names a tool, and it's a Process criterion the Outcome criteria already cover.
2	The Agent's record is well formatted and lists the open items.	Weight 2 isn't allowed. Two claims in one, and “well formatted” can't be checked.

- **Missing coverage.** There are no criteria for the build history, the network classification, the spend totals, the playable shipping, or the tickets. An agent could miss all of these and still score well.
- **Nothing for the bolt-on.** The Julia meeting shouldn't be in the prompt at all, so no criterion should reward it.
